



EXAMINATION NO.: _____

THE MALAWI NATIONAL EXAMINATIONS BOARD

2026 MALAWI SCHOOL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION EXAMINATION

HISTORY

Monday, 29 June

Subject Number: M081/I

Time Allowed: 1 hour

11:00 am – 12:00 pm

PAPER I

(50 marks)

Instructions

1. This paper contains 7 printed pages. Please check.
2. Write your **Examination Number** in the spaces provided on top of each page of this question paper.
3. The paper has **50 multiple choice** questions. Answer **all** the questions. Each question carries **1** mark.
4. Hand in your question paper to the invigilator when time is called to stop writing.

Question Number	Do not write in these columns	
1-5		
6-10		
11 - 15		
16 - 19		
20 - 25		
26 - 30		
31 - 35		
36 - 40		
41 - 45		
46 - 50		
Total		

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Turn over

1. What prevented the Yao from forming a single political leadership in Malawi?
 - A. instability in the area due to strong indigenous groups
 - B. lack of individuals who could easily organise people
 - C. the area was well organised by the local people
 - D. came in small groups at different times
2. Why did the Yao participate in Slave Trade?
 - A. to earn respect and praise
 - B. had signed treaties with Sultan of Oman
 - C. were encouraged by their religious leaders
 - D. were oriented by the Bisa
3. Which of the following factors contributed to Lomwe choice of settlement in Malawi?
 - A. Portuguese oppression
 - B. pressure on land
 - C. political instability
 - D. job opportunities
4. Which of the following was the social impact of the Ngoni on indigenous people?
 - A. assimilation of culture
 - B. building of stockade villages
 - C. introduction of new military tactics
 - D. protection from slave trade
5. What made Mzilikazi to divide his subjects into two groups before crossing the Limpopo River?
 - A. to capture more cattle
 - B. to conquer other tribes easily
 - C. to avoid the destruction of his clan
 - D. to increase his military strength
6. Which of the following formed the Amaholi class of the Ndebele society?
 - A. Sotho, Tswana, Kora
 - B. Shona, Rozwi, Leya
 - C. Sotho, Shona, Griqua
 - D. Rozwi, Kora, Khumalo
7. Which of the following were the reasons for the establishment of regimental system in the Ndebele society?
 1. maintaining law and order
 2. avoiding conquests from other tribes
 3. organising military campaigns
 4. granting hunting expeditions
 - A. 1 and 2
 - B. 1 and 3
 - C. 2 and 4
 - D. 3 and 4
8. Which of the following reasons forced the Ndebele leave Ekupumuleni?
 - A. It had a lot of wild animals.
 - B. It was a colony of the Boers.
 - C. It was surrounded by predatory tribes.
 - D. It was too close to Zululand.
9. What role did the local people in Central Africa play in the organisation of gold trade?
 - A. buying gold from the Arabs
 - B. mining gold for the chiefs
 - C. processing gold for the Arabs
 - D. distributing gold to the chiefs
10. Which of the following were among the trade items in the land of Zanj before the arrival of the Portuguese?
 - A. gin and guns
 - B. salt and cloths
 - C. gold and ivory
 - D. iron and chinaware

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11. Why did the Ndebele impose Nguni culture and language on the local people?
- protecting themselves against their enemies
 - forming a centralised political organisation
 - promoting unity among people
 - forming a mixed society
12. Why was Henry Morton Stanley sent to Africa around 1871?
- to help Livingstone in evangelism work
 - to find out if Livingstone was dead or alive
 - to explore the source of Zambezi river
 - to recommend Livingstone to Sultan Seyyid Said
13. What made the local leaders in Kapeni area dislike the Henry Henderson of the Blantyre Mission?
- He blocked the trade route.
 - He interfered in local politics.
 - He preached against obeying traditional rulers.
 - He denounced payment of tributes to chiefs.
14. Which of the following leaders of independent churches believed that African customs should not be neglected but to be purified and maintained?
- Henock Msokera Phiri
 - Charles Domingo
 - Yesaya Zerenji Mwase
 - Chalres Chidongo Chinula
15. Which of the following was a humanitarian factor for the British interest in Northern Rhodesia?
- suppression of slave trade
 - acquisition of minerals
 - need for farming land
 - desire for settlement place
16. Why did the Scottish missionaries make an appeal to the British government to occupy Nyasaland?
- to gain continuous territory from Rhodesia
 - to gain more land for farming
 - to protect their interest against the Portuguese
 - to mobilise Africans against hostile tribes
17. Which of the following was a recommendation made by the commission of inquiry set after Chilembwe uprising?
- All suspected Africans were to be sent into exile.
 - All Europeans in Nyasaland were to go back to their countries.
 - The colonial government was to re-open PIM.
 - The colonial government was to improve the welfare of Africans.
18. Which of the following projects by the Central African Federation did Nyasaland benefit?
- Hydro Electric Power on Shire river
 - Queen Elizabeth Central Hospital
 - M1 tarmac road
 - Ship vessel on lake Malawi
19. What made the Shona and Ndebele lose the revolts?
- Their leader Lobengula had died.
 - The British hired more armies from South Africa.
 - The Africans lacked unity from within.
 - The Africans in Southern Rhodesia lacked support from outside.

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20. Why was Elliot Kamwana deported to Seychelles by the colonial government?
- A. He attacked introduction of tithes in the missionary churches.
 - B. He accused the whites for illtreating Africans.
 - C. He discouraged African children from attending Western Schools.
 - D. He prophesied the end of the British rule by 1914.
21. What made Sir Harry Johnstone sign treaties with Chiefs in Nyasaland?
- A. to end the spread of Islam
 - B. to end slave trade
 - C. to prevent illegal migration of other Europeans
 - D. to suppress hostile African cultures
22. Why did the colonial administration decide to involve African peasants in commercial farming?
- A. Africans were better than Europeans in farming.
 - B. Africans had more cotton ginneries.
 - C. Africans were highly motivated in farming.
 - D. African Farmers Associations were well organised.
23. What role did the Islamic brotherhoods play in spreading Islam in Malawi between 1880 and 1930?
- A. They were involved in wars of convention among the local people.
 - B. They brought competition between Quadria and Shadria sects to gain more converts.
 - C. They encouraged different Islamic sects to sponsor traders to convert the locals.
 - D. They introduced technical colleges that attracted many locals to join them.
24. Why were land problems few in Northern Rhodesia?
- A. The population of Africans was few in the area.
 - B. The population of Europeans was few in the area.
 - C. There were strict laws on land ownership.
 - D. The land was already controlled by hostile chiefs.
25. What was the **negative** impact of the British South African Company administration policies on the local people?
- A. It led to development of African communities.
 - B. It disrupted African agricultural activities.
 - C. It helped in preparing Africans for independence.
 - D. It facilitated in exposing Africans to exploitation.

26. Which of the following reasons forced Russia to pull out of the Three Emperors League?
- A. Britain had persuaded Russia to leave.
 - B. Germany had failed to renew the treaty.
 - C. France had disturbed her imperial interest in Africa.
 - D. Austria-Hungary had picked a quarrel with her.
27. Which of the following treaties marked Britain's breakaway from the Splendid Isolation policy?
- A. Treaty of Bucharest
 - B. Anglo-Japanese Treaty
 - C. Treaty of London
 - D. Versailles Treaty
28. Why was the Balkan League formed in 1912?
- A. to reduce the size of the Turkish Empire
 - B. to consolidate power of member states
 - C. to assist member states in war
 - D. to encourage nationalism
29. Which of the following was a reason for Tsar's government survival after the 1905 revolution in Russia?
- A. It received assistance from Germany.
 - B. There was introduction of new currency.
 - C. It had constructed new road networks.
 - D. It had made promises in the October Manifesto.
30. Which of the following countries copied the Russian Communist Revolutions?
- A. France
 - B. Germany
 - C. Cuba
 - D. USA
31. Which of the following policies did USA adopt after the First World War?
- A. Isolationism
 - B. Totalitarianism
 - C. Self-determinism
 - D. Self-expansionism
32. Why did rich landowners hate the Bolsheviks in Russia?
- A. the government never listened to them
 - B. they lost their land due to land redistribution
 - C. they did not agree with the inclusion of Russia in the First World War
 - D. there was lack of transparency in the government
33. Why did the Politburo provide full support to Stalin during the power struggle in Russia?
- A. Members in the politburo had natural hatred against Stalin's opponents.
 - B. Members of the politburo considered other leaders as a threat.
 - C. Key positions in Politburo were given to supporters of Stalin.
 - D. The politburo firmly believed that Stalin had the magic.
34. Which of the following conflicts did the League of Nations fail to solve?
- A. Japan and China
 - B. Greece and Bulgaria
 - C. Finland and Sweden
 - D. Turkey and Iraq
35. Which of the following countries formed the Anschluss?
- A. Austria and Germany
 - B. Austria and Serbia
 - C. Germany and Russia
 - D. Russia and Serbia

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36. Which of the following was a **positive** impact of First World War on Japan?
A. declining of industrialisation
B. declining of population of the country
C. creation of Job opportunities
D. creation of economic problems
37. Why were the representatives of the Weimar Republic nicknamed "November Criminals"?
A. They came to power after being released from prison in November.
B. They signed the harsh terms of the Versailles treaty in November.
C. They betrayed Germany by joining the First World War in November.
D. They faced demonstrations from their opponents in the month of November.
38. Which of the following treaties was signed by the allies with Austria?
A. Treaty of Sevres
B. Treaty of Neuilly
C. Treaty of St. Germain
D. Treaty of Trianon
39. Which of the following financial assistance did Germany benefit from USA?
A. Great plan and Five Years plan
B. Dawes plan and Young plan
C. Great plan and Dawes plan
D. Young plan and Five Years plan
40. Which of the following territories did Japan occupy as a form of expansionism policy?
A. Maine land
B. Hawaii
C. Manchuria
D. Rhine land
41. Which of the following events enabled Hitler to test the preparedness of Germany army for war?
A. occupation of Rhineland
B. the Spanish civil war
C. attack on Czechoslovakia
D. attack on Poland
42. Why did the United States of America's entry into the Second World War act as a disadvantage to Germany and her Axis Powers?
A. USA came with fresh supplies.
B. USA was a strong nation militarily.
C. USA came with atomic bombs.
D. USA organised the Allied powers.
43. Which of the following strategies did American government use to protect local industries against foreign goods during the Great Depression?
A. increasing foreign investments
B. increasing tariffs on imports
C. reducing stock exchange rates
D. reducing prices of local products
44. Why has the United Nations Organisation failed to bring lasting peace in Middle East?
A. lack of permanent army
B. lack of funds for its operations
C. favours the western countries
D. fears the super powers
45. Why did most Indians criticise the Morley Minto Reforms?
A. They divided Indians on religious grounds.
B. They increased Indians representation in the council.
C. They only favoured the British.
D. They were influenced by Ghandi.

46. What were Hitler's motives for attacking Russia during the Second World War?
1. preventing Russia from occupying China
 2. preventing the spread of communism
 3. avoiding two frontal war
 4. revenging for Russian attack of Germany
- A. 1 and 2
B. 1 and 4
C. 2 and 3
D. 3 and 4
47. How was the failure of the Disarmament Conference related to the Appeasement Policy?
- A. When Germany pulled out of the conference, France and Britain attacked her.
- B. When Germany pulled out of the conference, Britain and France took no action
- C. When Germany pulled out of the conference, she started rearming.
- D. When Germany pulled out of the conference, she was isolated.
48. How did the British colonial policies lead to nationalism in India?
1. divided Indians
 2. united Indians
 3. made India poor
 4. oppressed the Indians
- A. 1 and 2
B. 1 and 3
C. 2 and 4
D. 3 and 4
49. How did the USA react to Fidel Castro's government?
- A. imposed economic sanctions on Cuba
- B. launched an abortive attack on Cuban army
- C. encouraged Cubans to rise against their leader
- D. expelled Cubans from USA
50. How did the Versailles Treaty create a power vacuum in Europe?
- A. made France and Britain to emerge as superpowers
- B. caused Germany to be militarily weak
- C. made Germany to be surrounded by weak states
- D. helped Germany to dominate the European continent

END OF QUESTION PAPER

NB: This paper contains 7 printed pages.